TASK 3: CAUSALITY ASSESSMENT OF ADVERSE DRUG REACTIONS

1. **Aim**

The aim of the task is to evaluate the relation between the suspected drug causing adverse reaction and the observed adverse reaction occurring in the body using a standard casuality assessment criteria.

This record is based on previously submitted ADR form.

2. Introduction

Causality assessment is an important part of pharmacovigilance. It helps determine whether an adverse drug reaction is related to a particular medicine.

It involves analysing the patient's medical history, drug administration timeline, symptoms, withdrawal of the suspected drug and other possible causes.

The drug that is recorded to have an adverse effect in this case is amoxicillin and the patient is experiencing skin rash, itching, pain in body after administration of medicine.

3. Patient Details

Parameter	**Details**
Patient	Male
Age	22 years
Suspected drug	Amoxicillin
Adverse reaction	Skin rash, Itching
Onset	1 day after starting the drug
Outcome	Patient recovered after stopping the drug

4. Medication History

- Amoxicillin: Started 1 days before evaluation.
- Paracetamol: Taken as needed.

5. Causality Assessment Criteria

A. Temporal Relationship

The patient developed a skin rash next day after starting amoxicillin.

Assessment: Positive temporal relationship.

B. Dechallenge

The patient recovered after stopping the suspected drug.

Assessment: Positive dechallenge.

C. Alternative Causes

Other possible causes, including other medicines, infections and underlying medical conditions, should be investigated.

Assessment: Not enough information available to exclude alternative causes.

D. Rechallenge

There is no information indicating whether the reaction reappeared after re-administration of amoxicillin.

Assessment: Unknown.

6. Causality Assessment Table

Criteria	**Observation**
Temporal relationship	Positive temporal relationship
Dechallenge	Positive dechallenge
Alternative causes	Not established due to lack of information
Rechallenge	Unknown

7. Final Causality Classification

Classification: Possible ADR (provisional)

Reason:

- The reaction occurred after administration of amoxicillin.
- Skin rash is a recognised adverse reaction associated with amoxicillin.
- The patient recovered after discontinuation.
- However, alternative causes have not been adequately excluded.

Further clinical information is required to classify the reaction as probable or certain.

8. Conclusion

The patient experienced a suspected adverse drug reaction in the form of a skin rash following amoxicillin administration.

The temporal relationship and positive dechallenge support a possible causal association between amoxicillin and the reaction.

Causality assessment is essential for identifying drug-related problems, improving patient safety and supporting appropriate pharmacovigilance reporting.

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